

CLUB/STATE TEAM OF THE YEAR

Mohun Bagan Super Giant

Discipline: Football

Mohun Bagan Super Giant had a memorable 2023-24 season as it won its maiden Indian Super League Shield and was the runner-up in the cup final. It maintained an Indian core throughout the season, employing India's national team regulars Manvir Singh, Sahal Abdul Samad, and Subhasish Bose in the starting XI under head coach Antonio Lopez Habas. Its midfielder, Dimitri Petratos, won the Golden Ball (best player) in the ISL while its goalkeeper, Vishal Kaith, bagged the Golden Glove in the Durand Cup. The Mariners started the season with silverware in style, beating arch-rival East Bengal in the Durand Cup final in Kolkata and becoming the most successful team in the tournament, with 17 titles. In the middle of the season, however, it changed coaches to steady the ship steady with Habas taking over as head coach. In the regular season, it scored the most goals by a team – 47 – which was five more than its closest contender, Mumbai City FC. After winning the Shield, Mohun Bagan secured qualification for Asia, playing in the AFC Cup, now rebranded as the AFC Champions League Two.

Achievements in the 2023-24 season:

- ★ Won the Durand Cup 2023, beating East Bengal in the final
- ★ MBSG goalkeeper Vishal Kaith won the Golden Glove in the Durand Cup 2023
- ★ Won maiden Indian Super League Shield
- ★ MBSG midfielder Dimitri Petratos won the Golden Ball in ISL
- ★ Qualified for AFC Champions League Two for the fourth consecutive time.



Mumbai Ranji Team

Discipline: Cricket

The Ranji Team of Mumbai, under captain Ajinkya Rahane, saw several stars emerge through the 2023-24 season as it clinched its record-extending 42nd title, beating Vidarbha in the final. It was the first Ranji title for Mumbai in nearly a decade, ending its eight-year drought for the coveted trophy. While the top order of Prithvi Shaw, Bhupen Lalwani, and Musheer Khan created a foundation for runs, the resilience of the lower order, Shardul Thakur, Tanush Kotian, and Tushar Deshpande, along with their wicket-taking ability, created a formidable unit for the eventual champion. In the quarterfinal, Mumbai came agonisingly close to a new record, with Kotian and Deshpande scoring a century each while putting up 232 runs together yet falling just one run shy of the highest partnership for the 10th wicket. Kotian won the Player of the Series with over 500 runs to his name and 29 wickets. Mumbai, with a major chunk of the Ranji side, also finished as a quarterfinalist at the Vijay Hazare Trophy and the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy.

Achievements in the 2023-24 season:

- ★ Won the Ranji Trophy after eight years, beating Vidarbha in the final
- ★ Tanush Kotian and Tushar Deshpande scored the second-highest partnership for the 10th wicket in the Ranji quarterfinal
- ★ Reached the quarterfinals of the Vijay Hazare Trophy
- ★ Reached the quarterfinals of the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy

